Tobias Treppmann

Director Design Strategy · Product direction, organization design, AI delivery and hands-on craft

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PROFILE

I work where product direction, team design and the quality of what ships meet. I have led Product and Design functions, advised executives and founders, and changed how teams make decisions and develop people. Current work keeps that advice practical through AI products, agentic prototypes and operational workflows built against real systems.

Five · nine
design-function and combined Product-and-Design spans

Research changed strategy
evidence overturned an automation-first direction

Strategy to shipped systems
product leadership grounded in delivery

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design
2025 – Present

Bibel TV (consumer streaming across iOS, Android, web and connected TV) *Hamburg + Berlin, Germany*

- Lead product design and product management for Bibel TV's streaming redesign, coordinating product direction, design and external engineering across four platforms.
- Design and agentically develop "Bibel erklärt" (working title), a conversational AI Bible-study application in development. I own product direction, UX, UI, motion and structured onboarding.
- Prototype in real code against production APIs with Claude Code. External engineering works from the web and Android prototypes and ships from their code.
- Built Bibel TV's fundraising system end to end: performance analysis, prompt architecture, guided web prototype and a Claude skill for coordinated in-app, web and video content.
- Designed and shipped a Microsoft Copilot support workflow that follows the team handbook and house voice while staff review, edit and send every answer.
- Created a cross-platform design-system foundation using Storybook, DTCG tokens, automated checks and accessible color generation to make implementation quality repeatable.

Independent Product & Design Consultant
2016 – Present

Oratio&Co (selected work alongside leadership roles) *Berlin, Germany · Remote*

- Own client relationships from discovery through strategy, workshops, prototypes and delivery guidance, working with startups and established companies including Software AG, Bibel TV and Ninox.
- Designed Ninox's prompt-to-database onboarding with the CEO. The generated schema renders in the real editor beside chat so people can inspect and change it directly.
- Advised Bibel TV on human-centered design and facilitated product-strategy and UX workshops before later joining the organization in an operating role.

Head of Platform and Design
2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical SaaS across six European markets) *Berlin, Germany · Copenhagen HQ*

- Led product management and design for a vertical platform operating under GDPR and church data-protection requirements.
- Reframed a funeral-booking request as a reusable platform capability in the existing calendar and form builder; coordination time fell by an estimated 70% and booking acceptance reached 90%.
- Served as the launch customer's primary product contact, translating stakeholder needs, operational rules and technical constraints into an integrated product direction.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product
2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform across DACH, the UK and the US) *Berlin, Germany*

- Senior Leadership Team member with five direct reports across product design and UX writing; hired two people, promoted two and coached the design lead.
- Led Product and Design together for four months across nine people in product design, UX writing, product management and data science.
- Designed the team operating system: leveling framework, performance reviews, growth plans and joint design-system governance with Engineering.
- Kept strategy close to product quality through hands-on design direction, executive alignment and work across the product portfolio.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared-services arm of listed Hypoport SE) *Berlin, Germany*

- Helped department heads move bespoke internal services toward standardized, productized offers through recurring workshops, reviews and coaching.
- Facilitated executive and cross-functional sessions on service strategy, design thinking, governance and organizational change.
- Connected user-centered methods with operating reality in a complex shared-services organization rather than producing a strategy document that teams could not use.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (enterprise data analytics for regulated banks and insurers) *Berlin · team across Germany and New York*

- Led two UX designers across Germany and New York and moved design and research upstream into strategic product decisions.
- Designed data-dense analytics and uncertainty states for specialist users in regulated financial organizations.
- Built a research method for hard-to-reach specialists and used evidence to shape roadmap conversations with executives and product leaders.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international print-on-demand marketplace) *Leipzig, Germany*

- Led a nine-month seller-experience redesign after two previous attempts had failed; the work grew from a three-person team into larger implementation teams.
- Used in-person research to challenge an automation-first direction. Shop owners valued creative control, so the product direction moved toward controlled automation.
- Built a mobile t-shirt designer prototype that tested strongly and moved into production, then facilitated executive workshops to align Product, Engineering and business leaders.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, Pennsylvania, USA · product and UX work in a 30-person design agency

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · coaching and mentoring product designers

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA · consumer e-commerce

Web Designer / Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, Pennsylvania, USA

EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership
Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design strategy and consulting

product vision · research synthesis · roadmaps · executive facilitation · client leadership · workshop design · organizational change · service productization

Product and organization leadership

operating models · team structures · decision rights · hiring · coaching · promotions · performance reviews · leveling frameworks · design operations

AI products and agentic delivery

conversational UX · Claude Code · MCP · MS Copilot · n8n · prompt and context design · human-in-the-loop workflows · prototypes against real APIs

Product craft and systems

interaction design · high-fidelity UI · motion · accessibility · Figma · Storybook · DTCG design tokens · iOS · Android · web · connected TV

International leadership

native German · English C2 · Berlin-based · distributed teams across Europe and the US · client travel by arrangement